

View results

Respondent

39

Anonymous

38:51

Time to complete

A. General information about the respondent

1. * Country

Albania



2. * Name of organization(s) or entity(s) responsible for the preparation of the report

Ministry of Education and Sports

3. * Website of organization(s) or entity(s) responsible for the preparation of the report

<https://arsimi.gov.al/>

4. * Email address of organization(s) or entity(s) responsible for the preparation of the report

5. Phone number of organization(s) or entity(s) responsible for the preparation of the report

N/A

6. Please describe the role/mandate of your organization

The Ministry of Education and Sport designs and implements policies aimed at ensuring a quality educational system, fostering the prospective development of education, respecting the interests of individuals, the community, and society, and equipping individuals with the necessary knowledge to meet the demands of the market economy, in accordance with national and European priorities. It is also responsible for the creation, transmission, development, and protection of knowledge through teaching, scientific research, and services. The Ministry of Education and Sports designs and implements policies for the development of scientific research and innovation in support of the country's development policies.

7. * Full name of officially designated contact person(s) who completed this survey

Ms. Mirela Cami

8. * Position of officially designated contact person(s) who completed this survey

General Director, General Directorate for the Development of Higher Education and Scientific Research

9. * Email address of officially designated contact person(s) who completed this survey

10. Full Name(s) of designated official(s) certifying the report

Ms. Ana Kapaj, Deputy Minister, Ministry of Education and Sports

11. Brief description of the consultation process established for the preparation of the report

The preparation of the report went through a consultation and collaborative process with key stakeholders in the education and research sectors. The Ministry of Education coordinated the process, working in close collaboration with the Academy of Sciences, National Agency of Scientific Research (NASRI), Albanian Academic Network (AAN) and all Higher Education Institutions (HEI-s). These institutions provided their information and data, to ensure an evidence-based report. The process included consultations, meetings, to align the results with national and international priorities in higher education and scientific research.

12. * Name of other organization(s) or entit(y)(ies) (including non-governmental) consulted for completing this survey

National Agency of Scientific Research (NASRI) Albanian Academic Network (AAN) Academy of Sciences of Albania (ASA) Agency of Innovation and Excellence (AIE) Ministry of Economy, Culture and Innovation (MECI) Higher Education Institutions, (HEI-s)

13. * Website of other organization(s) or entit(y)(ies) (including non-governmental) consulted for completing this survey
(Please use commas to separate multiple links, as: link A, link B)

<https://arsimi.gov.al/> , <https://nasri.gov.al/> , <https://akad.gov.al/> , <https://www.rash.al/en/> ,
<https://unitir.edu.al/> , <https://www.ubt.edu.al/sq> , <https://uamd.edu.al/> , <https://upt.edu.al/>

14. * Email address of other organization(s) or entit(y)(ies) (including non-governmental) consulted for completing this survey

N/A

15. Sector of other organization(s) or entit(y)(ies) (including non-governmental) consulted for completing this survey

☒ Public

☒ Private

☐ Civil Society

☐ Other

B. QUESTIONNAIRE FOR MEMBER STATES' REPORTING

ON THE IMPLEMENTATION OF THE 2021 RECOMMENDATION ON OPEN SCIENCE

Part 1. PROMOTING A COMMON UNDERSTANDING OF OPEN SCIENCE,

ASSOCIATED BENEFITS AND CHALLENGES, AS WELL AS DIVERSE PATHS TO OPEN
SCIENCE

16. 1.1 Has the 2021 UNESCO Recommendation on Open Science been promoted and/or shared with appropriate ministries and institutions as well as affiliated organizations in your country?



Yes



No

17. 1.1 cont. **If yes**, please indicate which ministries and or national authorities/entities have been involved in the promotion of the 2021 Recommendation.

The 2021 UNESCO Recommendation on Open Science has been promoted and shared, from key institutions, such as the Ministry of Education and Sport (MoES), the National Agency for Scientific Research and Innovation (NASRI), the Academy of Sciences, the Agency for Innovation and Excellence (AIE) and Higher Education Institutions (HEI-s). These institutions are working to align Albania's science and innovation policies with the principles outlined in the UNESCO recommendation, fostering an open science environment at the national level. The Ministry of Education and Sports (MoES) plays an important role in designing education and research policies in Albania, including those related to open science. In recent years, the Ministry of Education and Sports has been working on aligning the country's research policies with international standards, including those set by UNESCO. Efforts made by MoES to promote open science include integration into national strategies and legal framework. The Ministry has included the principles of open science within the National Strategy for Science, Technology, and Innovation (2023-2030), which highlights the importance of transparency, data sharing, and open access to research outputs as well as in The Law No. 109/2024 "On science and scientific research in Republic of Albania", in Republic of Albania approved in 2024. As part of alignment with international initiatives, the MoES also encourages participation in EU-funded programs like Horizon Europe, which places a strong emphasis on open science and research transparency. National Agency for Scientific Research and Innovation (NASRI), as the institution responsible for managing national research funds, has been a significant actor in promoting open science in Albania. NASRI has supported and funded research projects that apply open science practices, such as open access publishing and data sharing, by providing financial resources to universities and research institutions. The Academy of Sciences has played a role in advancing the open science agenda. The contributions include promoting Open Science in the Scientific Community. The Academy of Sciences has hosted discussions, workshops, focused on promoting open science, where academics/experts from Albania and abroad present best practices aligned with the UNESCO Recommendation. These events aimed to raise awareness and foster an open science culture within the scientific community. Regarding research dissemination and collaboration, the Academy of Sciences also facilitates the dissemination of research outputs through national and international collaborations, which increasingly emphasize open access and data sharing. The Agency for Innovation and Excellence (AIE) has been also promoting open science practices, especially in the context of innovation, technology, and entrepreneurship. Some of the AIE's efforts related to open science include supporting Open Access research. AIE provides financial support to projects that promote open science, including those focusing on the development of open-access platforms for scientific publications and research data. AIE also supports the establishment of research centers and innovation hubs, encouraging the adoption of open science practices to foster collaboration between universities, research institutions, and the private sector. Higher education institutions, HEI-s have been engaged as well through dedicated meetings and round tables to raise awareness of open science principles. Additionally, the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science has been integrated into national discussions on research policies, ensuring alignment with European for open access, data sharing, and scientific collaboration. Web pages of HEI-s have also been used to enable dissemination and engagement with researchers and academic staff.

18. 1.2 Is the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science available in the national language(s) of your country?

☒ Yes

☐ No

19. 1.2 cont. **If yes**, which language(s)?

Albanian Language

20. 1.3 Have there been awareness raising activities on open science, including all its key elements[i], associated benefits and challenges, organized or foreseen to be organized by the end of 2025 in your country by national authorities or entities? (ref.: (i) 16.f, 16.g, 16.h)

[i] Please refer to the elements of open science defined in the 2021 Recommendation, namely : open scientific knowledge (including open access to scientific publications, research data, open educational resources, open-source software and code, open hardware), open science infrastructures, open engagement of societal actors and open dialogue with other knowledge systems.

☒ Yes

☐ No

21. 1.3 cont. **If yes**, please provide details on the activities organized or foreseen and links as relevant.

Several institutions have already performed many awareness-raising activities on open science, in line with the UNESCO 2021 Recommendation, which emphasizes values and principles of open science, open scientific knowledge, open science infrastructures, open engagement of societal actors, and open dialogue with other knowledge systems. These activities are organized by national authorities and institutions, including the Ministry of Education and Sport (MoES), the National Agency for Scientific Research and Innovation (NASRI), the Academy of Sciences (ASA), the Agency for Innovation and Excellence (AIE), and Higher Education Institutions (HEI-s). The Ministry of Education and Sports has planned and supported round tables and meetings with key actors on Open Science focusing on the values and principles of Open Science, benefits of open access publications, and the importance of open science infrastructures. As part of participation in EU programs like Horizon Europe, the Ministry and NASRI also performs awareness-raising events targeting policymakers, researchers, and students. National Agency for Scientific Research and Innovation (NASRI) plays an important role in promoting of open science practices across Albania. NASRI in close collaboration with MoES has organized with academic staff/researchers several Open Science Seminars and Training Sessions. The Academy of Science has been involved as well as in raising awareness about open science. The Academy has published reports and organized discussions on the benefits of open scientific knowledge, especially regarding open access publications and open educational resources (OER). The Agency for Innovation and Excellence (AIE) has been supporting open science as part of Albania's innovation ecosystem. AIE hosts innovation hubs and workshops that promote the integration of open-source software and code, and open hardware in Albanian start-ups and research institutions. These activities are designed to raise awareness about how these open science practices can drive innovation and collaboration in the tech industry. Higher Education Institutions (HEI-s) are actively engaging in open science awareness-raising activities. HEI-s in Albania, particularly through their research departments have organized round tables and seminars for students and faculty. These seminars focus on open science elements like open access publishing, the use of open educational resources (OER), and how to engage with societal actors in research projects. These awareness days aimed at educating academic staff, researchers, about the principles of open science and how it can improve the transparency, accessibility, and impact of scientific research. https://www.facebook.com/story.php?story_fbid=1042002591290205&id=100064414223556&mibextid=wwXlfr&rdid=NajzKIMSNwuQATXG# , <https://www.facebook.com/photo?fbid=911560591152851&set=pcb.911560944486149> , <https://cit.edu.al/supporting-quality-research-in-albania-2016-2018/> , <https://cit.edu.al/how-to-handle-scientific-research-open-lecture/> , <https://cit.edu.al/the-future-2030-conference/> , <https://cit.edu.al/intellectual-property-and-its-importance-in-promoting-innovation-among-students-informative-session/> , <https://cit.edu.al/save-the-date-seminar-on-friday-7th-of-may-2021-at-1400/>

22. 1.4 Have specific actions been undertaken or are planned to be undertaken by end of 2025 in your country to incorporate the values and principles of open science[i], in publicly funded research? (ref.: (i) 16.a, 16.b, 16.c, 16.d, 16.e, 16.h)

[i] The 2021 Recommendation outlines a set of shared values of open science stemming from the rights-based, ethical, epistemological, economic, legal, political, social, multi-stakeholder and technological implications of opening science to society and broadening the principles of openness to the whole cycle of scientific research. It also provides a set of guiding principles, as a framework for enabling conditions and practices, which uphold the values of open science and can realize the ideals of open science.

Please see the values of open science, namely quality and integrity, collective benefit, equity and fairness, and diversity and inclusiveness.

Please see the guiding principles for open science ,namely transparency, scrutiny, critique and reproducibility; equality of opportunities; responsibility, respect and accountability; collaboration, participation and inclusion; flexibility and sustainability.

☒ Yes

☐ No

23. 1.4 cont. If **yes**, please indicate the actions that are taken to incorporate the specific values and principles. For each case, please provide details and links as relevant.

The MoES has aligned its strategies for science and education with international open science principles, particularly as outlined in the UNESCO 2021 Recommendation. The National Strategy for Science, Technology, and Innovation (2023-2030) includes open science principles, emphasizing the need to make publicly funded research outputs accessible. NASRI has been another actor in promoting open science within publicly funded research. NASRI has been integrating open science principles into its research funding criteria. Specifically, researchers applying for grants are encouraged to follow principles of open access and data sharing as part of their research proposals. NASRI is also supporting the development of open science infrastructures. These infrastructures are expected to support the transparent dissemination of research data and findings from publicly funded projects. The Academy of Sciences facilitates public dialogue between researchers and the public to ensure that research is aligned with societal needs and that it has an impact on real challenges. It encourages publicly funded researchers to share their publications, research data, and findings through open-access platforms. AAN also supports the adoption of open educational resources in higher education institutions, promoting the use of free and accessible learning materials, including textbooks and software, to improve the quality of education. AIE supports the development of open-source software and open hardware by publicly funded researchers. By facilitating open innovation, AIE ensures that research outputs are publicly accessible and usable by the broader scientific and innovation community. AIE is contributing to foster joint research between academic institutions and industry, ensuring that publicly funded research benefits not just academia but society and the economy as well. The Technology Park is developing platforms and infrastructures that allow publicly funded research data to be freely shared and accessed. These infrastructures are key enablers for open science, providing a space for data repositories, collaborative research, and open-access publishing. The Technology Park facilitates collaboration between researchers, startups, and industries, promoting the development of open-source technologies and fostering an open innovation culture in Albania. The Technology Park is working to connect Albanian researchers with international open science networks, providing opportunities for cross-border collaboration and knowledge sharing. <https://nasri.gov.al/aktiviteti-open-science-era/> , <https://ni4os.rash.al/en/news/2022/12/24/albanian-open-science-day> , <https://www.rash.al/sq/software/universitare/u-cris/> , <https://akad.gov.al/botime/> , <https://www.aicorporation.al/sq/lajme/lanimi-i-durana-tech-park-dhe-nnshkrimi-i-marrveshjes-mes-meki-dhe-aic->

Part 2. DEVELOPING AN ENABLING POLICY ENVIRONMENT FOR OPEN SCIENCE

24. 2.1 Does your country have a national policy[i], strategy or plan of action on science, technology and innovation (STI)?

[i] National STI policy is most commonly a governmental document developed by governing bodies leading the STI policy design and implementation in a given country, which formulates objectives and guides actions and decision-making processes in the area of STI on the national level.

☒ Yes

☐ No

25. 2.1 cont. **If yes**

- please share a machine-readable PDF file of the policy using this link: <https://tinyurl.com/27p5zct8> designating openscience@unesco.org as the recipient, and provide the following information: *Title of the policy, the authority in charge of development of the policy, entities involved and the process of development, year of adoption, year of last update, key areas/sections of the policy, and links to the webpage if available.*

In the comment box, please indicate the question number for this attachment / document.

After uploading, please return to this page to continue the survey.

The Law No. 109/2024 "On science and scientific research in Republic of Albania", approved in 2024 is a significant step toward modernizing the framework of STI and ensuring that it aligns with European Union standards and best practices. The law aims to establish a clear, coherent framework for scientific research and technological innovation, facilitating the integration of Albania into the European Research Area (ERA) and enhancing collaboration with international research networks. The Law No. 109/2024 "On science and scientific research in Republic of Albania", emphasis open science principles, encouraging the sharing of scientific knowledge, research data, and results to foster greater collaboration and innovation.

<https://qbz.gov.al/share/CziCAqPkQiWqQq4TCnGR-g>
<https://qbz.gov.al/eli/ligj/2024/10/31/109/1ad3354e-0611-4997-bdcf-3e4526ae2f50>

National Strategy for Scientific Research, Technology, and Innovation 2023–2030 sets a clear direction for the country's scientific and technological advancement, with a focus on research improvement, European integration, and sustainable development. This strategic document sets the framework for Albania's Science Technology and Innovation (STI) development, aiming to improve the country's scientific research capacity, foster innovation, and integrate technology in the national economy. The strategy focuses on creating an innovative ecosystem that encourages collaboration between universities, research institutions, and the private sector, and it highlights the importance of aligning with European Union standards in terms of research, innovation, and science policy. Some of key objectives are: Enhancing Research and Innovation: Fostering research and innovation in higher education and across public and private sectors. Building Research Infrastructure: Improving national research infrastructures to promote open science and ensure access to high-quality data, publications, and research facilities. Boosting International Cooperation: Strengthening Albania's participation in European research programs, particularly Horizon Europe, and supporting international research collaborations. NASRI is responsible for managing public research funding and is an important institution for implementing the national STI strategy because it allocates funding for scientific research projects and promotes innovation in various fields. NASRI plays an active role in implementing actions within the National Strategy for Science, Technology, and Innovation by supporting projects that prioritize technological advancement and scientific innovation in Albania. AIE is also a player in implementing national STI policies, specifically promoting innovation ecosystems, supporting technology parks, and fostering collaboration between research institutions, the private sector, and startups.

<https://www.rash.al/sq/software/universitare/u-cris/> , <https://akad.gov.al/botime/> , <https://unitir.edu.al/category/dok/>

26. 2.1 cont. **If yes:**

- does it include any of the following open science elements:

- ☒ open access to scientific knowledge
- ☒ open science infrastructure
- ☒ open engagement of societal actors
- ☒ open dialogue with other knowledge systems

27. 2.2 In your country, is there a policy, or a set of policies and/or legal framework(s)[i] at the national level that address open science or any of its key elements in line with the definition, values and principles outlined in the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science? (*ref.: (i) 16.a, 16.b, 16.c, 16.d, 16.e, 16.h*)

[i] These can include specific national policies, sets of guidelines, rules, regulations, laws, principles, or directions to govern open science practices.

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ Partly
- ☐ No

28. 2.2 cont. **If yes or partly**, please share a machine-readable PDF file(s) of the policy(ies) using this link: <https://tinyurl.com/27p5zct8> designating openscience@unesco.org as the recipient, and provide the following information for each: *Title of the policy or legal instrument, the authority in charge of development of the policy, entities involved and the process of development, year of adoption, year of last update, key areas/sections of the policy, elements of open science that are addressed, and links to the webpage(s) if available.*

The Law No. 109/2024 "On science and scientific research in Republic of Albania", approved in 2024, is a cornerstone of effort to align scientific and technological policies with European standards, including the principles of open science. The law encourages making scientific publications freely accessible, in line with open access principles. This is important for increasing the visibility and impact of Additionally, in this context, the elaboration of the concept of open science has continued in Article 24 of this law, which states: "The scientific researcher is obliged: a) to implement the statute and regulations of the research institution; b) to respect the code of ethics; c) to implement the research activity program; d) to respect the principles of open science; e) to follow the mandatory qualification programs established by the internal acts of the research institution". Based on point 6 of Article 5 of Law No. 109/2024 "On science and scientific research in Republic of Albania", the standards and criteria that enable the implementation of the open science principle and are in line with the policies of the European Research Area are expected to be determined and approved by a decision of the Council of Ministers as a necessary act for the implementation of this law and the concept of open science

<https://qbz.gov.al/eli/ligj/2024/10/31/109/1ad3354e-0611-4997-bdcf-3e4526ae2f50> National Strategy for Science, Technology, and Innovation 2023-2030 emphasizes the need for fostering open access to research publications, open data, and collaborative platforms for sharing research outputs. It also encourages the integration of digital infrastructures that support open science principles in both public and private research sectors.

<https://qbz.gov.al/share/CziCAqPkQiWqQq4TCnGR-g>

29. 2.3 In your country, are there specific policy instruments[i] that aim to promote open science?

[i] Policy instruments include programmes, methods and mechanisms of technical and operational nature, required to solve the issues set by the policy, with focus on the target beneficiaries, resources, indicators, and set of goals for delivering products (short term), results (medium-term), and impacts (long term).



Yes



Under development



No

30. 2.3 cont. **If yes or under development**, please provide details and links as relevant, including for each instrument: *Title of the instrument, its objective, the authority in charge, allocated budget, elements of open science included.*

National Strategy for Scientific Research, Technology, and Innovation 2023–2030 is a policy instrument in effort to promote open science. It is aligned with EU frameworks, such as Horizon Europe, and includes various initiatives aimed at ensuring that scientific knowledge is shared openly and accessible to the public. The Law on Scientific Research and Innovation, approved in 2024, is another policy instrument that explicitly supports open science principles. The Ministry of Education and Sports, in collaboration with NASRI and National Agency for the Information Society (NAIS) is working on the development of the ACRIS platform. This platform will serve as a dynamic database that will promote Open Science and will contain all research products in our country. The Center for Coordination and Dissemination of Scientific Information (CCDSI) is a unit within the Academy of Sciences of Albania (ASA) that coordinates the joint online network of information and research centers in Albania, through the COBISS.AL platforms (The online bibliographic system and shared services in Albania) and ECRIS.AL (The information system for research activity in Albania) for digitization, growth, and enrichment with indexed information, as well as access to content related to scientific creativity in Albania and beyond. (For more information, please refer to: <https://akad.gov.al/qendra-e-koordinimit-dheperhapies-se-informacionit-shkencor-qkpish/> ; <https://al.cobiss.net/sherbimi-cobiss-shqiptar/>) At the national level, 890 scientific researchers are registered in the ECRIS.AL system. The digitization of scientific publications by the Academy is done through the dCOBISS platform (Digital Repository COBISS) <https://al.cobiss.net/repositori-digjital/>. <https://qbz.gov.al/eli/vendim/2023/09/20/542/96f316d6-b135-42fb-a64a-abbbfa9484c8> <https://qbz.gov.al/eli/ligj/2024/10/31/109/1ad3354e-0611-4997-bdcf-3e4526ae2f50>

31. 2.4 In your country, is there a national implementation plan, strategy, policy or a roadmap for implementation of open science at the national level in line with the 2021 Recommendation? (ref.: (ii) 17.a, 17.b, 17.c, 17.f, 17.h)



Yes



Under development



No

32. 2.4 cont. **If yes or under development**, please provide details and links as relevant, including the name of ministries and national authorities/entities, as well as affiliated organizations that are involved in the development and implementation of the plan, strategy or the roadmap.

National Strategy for Scientific Research, Technology, and Innovation 2023–2030 is a policy instrument in effort to promote open science. It is aligned with EU frameworks, such as Horizon Europe, and includes various initiatives aimed at ensuring that scientific knowledge is shared openly and accessible to the public. The Law on Scientific Research and Innovation, approved in 2024, is another policy instrument that explicitly supports open science principles. Based on the policy documents, NASRI provide grants for scientific research, with a particular focus on ensuring that the results are shared openly. The agency encourages applicants to adopt open access policies and make their research data publicly available. NASRI supports and provide funds for projects that foster public-private partnerships and collaborations between research institutions, universities, and the private sector, ensuring that the outputs of research are accessible and beneficial to society. AIE offers funding and support for innovative projects, including those that utilize open science practices, such as the use of open data, and collaborations with research networks. Technology Parks and Innovation Hubs (e.g., Durrës Technology Park) provide infrastructure and support for startups, spin-offs, and businesses focused on scientific research and technological innovation. Many of these enterprises are encouraged to adopt open science practices, including sharing data and research results with the wider scientific community. Technology parks foster collaboration between research institutions, universities, and industry. Open science principles, such as open data and open collaboration, are promoted in this context.

<https://qbz.gov.al/share/CziCAqPkQiWqQq4TCnGR-g>
<https://www.aicorporation.al/sq/lajme/lanimi-i-durana-tech-park-dhe-nnshkrimi-i-marrveshjes-mes-meki-dhe-aic->

33. 2.5 In your country, are there policies and/or strategies that promote open science in line with the 2021 Recommendation at **institutional** level, including in the context of research-performing institutions, universities, scientific unions and associations and learned societies? (ref.: (ii) 17.d, 17.e, 17.g)



Yes



Under development



No

34. 2.5 cont. **If yes**, please provide more information, including the number of policies, name of the institute(s) that has/have developed the policy(s) and elements of open science included in the policy (please consider policies and strategies addressing all elements of open science, including citizen and participatory science, or co-production of knowledge with multiple actors). To view the elements of open science, see: <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379949/PDF/379949eng.pdf.multi.nameddest=20/p.nameddest=20/.page=9>

National Strategy for Scientific Research, Technology, and Innovation 2023–2030 and the Law No. 109/2024 “On science and scientific research in Republic of Albania”, are very important instruments that encourage and support open science principles. HEI-s and research institutions are increasingly aligning their practices with open science principles. HEI-s have adopted policies that require researchers to make their work publicly available, especially in terms of data and findings. They often offer training programs to equip researchers with the skills to implement open science practices, such as using open data repositories and publishing in open-access journals. There are several HEI-s that based on this promotion have performed awareness activities on open science and have designed their action plans. Vendim-Senati-Akademik-Miratimi-i-Dokumentit-te-Politikes-se-Shkences-se-Hapur.pdf
RekomandimetUNESCOsShkencaHapur2021.pdf We are also working to align our policies with Horizon Europe program, which emphasizes open science. This alignment is helping institutionalize open science principles at the national level, ensuring that researchers and institutions hold to international standards for open access and collaboration.
<https://arsimi.gov.al/prezantohet-dokumenti-i-politikave-te-arsimit-te-larte-2030-manastirliu-nderkombetarizim-i-universiteteve-dhe-skeme-e-re-financimi-sipas-performances-akademike/>

35. 2.6 In your country, are there specific funding mechanisms[i] for open science at the national level? (ref.: (ii) 17.j, (iii) 18.j, (iv) 19.c)

[i] A funding mechanism refers to a policy instrument or process through which financial resources are allocated or provided for a specific purpose. Some examples are block funding, research grants, support for technological poles and centres of excellence, support for science parks and innovation centres, Infrastructure grants (for research facilities, labs, instruments), communication and outreach funds, innovation funds, loans and tax credits scholarships, studentships, fellowships, trust funds, sectoral funds.



Yes



Under development



No

36. 2.6 cont. **If yes or under development**, please provide details and links as relevant.

Albania has established several funding mechanisms at the national level to support open science initiatives. These mechanisms aim to foster innovation, strengthen research capacities, and promote collaboration between academia, industry, and government institutions. National Agency for Scientific Research and Innovation (NASRI): NASRI plays an important role in financing scientific research activities in Albania. It manages public funding allocated to universities and research institutes, supporting both fundamental and applied research projects. NASRI's funding is implemented through national research and development projects, as well as bilateral and multilateral scientific cooperation projects. <https://nasri.gov.al/infrastruktura/> , <https://nasri.gov.al/drejtoria-e-programeve-kombetare-2/> Business and Investment Development Strategy (BIDS) 2021-2027: The BIDS outlines Albania's strategic approach to fostering economic growth through innovation and entrepreneurship. It emphasizes the importance of strengthening cooperation between companies, research organizations, and technology parks. The strategy includes measures to support start-ups and spin-offs, aiming to enhance competitiveness and promote sustainable economic development. https://www.investment.com.al/wp-content/uploads/2021/07/EN_Draft-BIDS-Presentation.pdf Durana Tech Park: The Durana Tech Park is a significant initiative aimed at developing a science and technology park in Albania. It focuses on creating an environment helpful to innovation and entrepreneurship, providing infrastructure and support services for start-ups and spin-offs. The park is designed to facilitate collaboration between academia, industry, and government, fostering a vibrant ecosystem for technological advancement. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MLudbYSXAQM> Tax Incentives for Start-ups and Spin-offs: Albania offers tax incentives to encourage the growth of start-ups and spin-offs. These incentives include exemptions from personal income tax and surtax for employees and other engaged persons for up to five years from the establishment date. Additionally, companies investing in start-ups or spin-offs may be eligible for corporate income tax exemptions on profits reinvested in these entities. These funding mechanisms and initiatives collectively aim to create a robust environment for open science, technological innovation, and entrepreneurial growth in Albania. <https://startupalbania.al/>

37. 2.7 1.1 In your country, have open science practices[i] been integrated in existing research funding mechanisms?

[i] Examples can include sharing open scientific knowledge (publications, research data, educational resources, software and hardware) with other scientists and with the public, sharing or using open infrastructures, collaboration with other researchers, with national and local societal actors such as policy makers, or sectors such as industry, agriculture, and health, and collaboration and open dialogue with indigenous peoples and local communities.



Yes



No

38. 2.7 cont. **If yes**, please provide details and links as relevant.

Open science practices are integrated into existing research funding mechanisms, with an emphasis on sharing scientific knowledge, promoting open infrastructures, and encouraging collaboration across different sectors. NASRI requires that research funded through its grants follow open access principles. This includes making research publications and data openly available to the public through online repositories and platforms. Researchers are required to ensure that the results of publicly funded research are accessible without paywalls. As part of the funding process, researchers are encouraged to share research data in publicly accessible open data repositories. Horizon Europe also mandates the use of open access for all publications resulting from funded projects. Researchers must deposit publications and data in open access repositories. Projects often include cross-border collaboration, and participants are required to follow open science practices by sharing knowledge and research outputs across institutional and national boundaries. The government, through NASRI and AIE, supports public-business partnerships in several areas. These collaborations often involve shared research data and open dialogue with stakeholders from the private sector, ensuring that research outcomes benefit both science and

<https://nasri.gov.al/wp-content/uploads/2024/12/THIRRJE-P%C3%8BR-PROJEKT-PROPOZIME-T%C3%8B-K%C3%8BRKIMIT-DHE-ZHVILLIMIT-PKKZH-N%C3%8B-KUAD%C3%8BR-T%C3%8B-PROGRAMEVE-KOMB%C3%8BTARE-P%C3%8BR-VITIN-2025-1.pdf>

39. 2.8 Have efforts been made or are foreseen to be undertaken by end of 2025 in your country to foster equitable public-private partnerships on open science in line with the 2021 Recommendation? (ref.: (ii) 17.i)

☒ Yes

☐ No

40. 2.8 cont. **If yes**, please provide details and links as relevant.

NASRI through its calls encourage the private sector to partner with research institutions in projects that are open and accessible to everyone, with shared benefits. Research outcomes must be openly shared and made accessible to all, ensuring that the knowledge is not confined to one party. <https://nasri.gov.al/wp-content/uploads/2024/12/THIRRJE-P%C3%8BR-PROJEKT-PROPOZIME-N%C3%8B-KUAD%C3%8BR-T%C3%8B-PROGRAMEVE-KOMB%C3%8BTARE-T%C3%8B-TEKNOLOGJIS%C3%8B-DHE-INOVACIONIT-PTI-2025-2.pdf> Technology parks and innovation hubs, such as the Durana Technology Park, bring together researchers, entrepreneurs, and businesses to collaborate on open science projects that are accessible to all stakeholders, ensuring that the results are shared openly and can be used by different actors. <https://www.aicorporation.al/en/projects/durana-technology-and-science-park> Academy of Science, among the projects with state or international funding, implemented at the Research Center for Biotechnology and Genetics, particularly in the fields of Plant and Animal Biotechnology, a significant collaboration has been achieved with the private sector interested in the scientific research results offered by the projects.

41. 2.9 Is there a national monitoring framework for open science in your country? Or are there specific indicators on open science included in the national monitoring and evaluation framework for STI policy (ref.: (ii) 17.j, 23.c)

☒ Yes

☐ Under development

☐ No

42. 2.9 cont. **If yes or under development**, please provide details and links as relevant.

We do not have a national monitoring framework specifically dedicated to open science. However, several initiatives and frameworks are being designed or implemented to track and evaluate the progress of Science Technology and Innovation (STI) policies, which may indirectly contribute to monitoring open science practices. The National Strategy for Scientific Research, Technology, and Innovation 2023–2030 outlines the strategic goals for Albania's STI situation. This strategy incorporates key STI indicators that can be used to track progress in areas related to open science. For example, monitoring the number of open access publications, open research data, and open-source software produced within the country; number of partnerships between research institutions and industry, especially those fostering open innovation and open access to research results. NASRI, also includes elements related to open access as part of their funding requirements, which are monitored as part of project evaluations. The Ministry of Education and Sports, in collaboration with NASRI, ASA, AAN, and HEI-s, will design a national monitoring framework dedicated to open science.

Part 3. INVESTING IN OPEN SCIENCE INFRASTRUCTURES AND SERVICES

43. 3.1 What is the latest official data for your country's percentage of national gross domestic product (GDP) dedicated to research and development expenditure? Please also indicate the year of publication of this data, and to which year(s) it refers. (ref.: (iii) 18.a)

Year 2024, 0.08% of GDP invested for R&D 2022, https://neighbourhood-enlargement.ec.europa.eu/document/download/a8eec3f9-b2ec-4cb1-8748-9058854dbc68_en?filename=Albania%20Report%202024.pdf

44. 3.2 What is the latest official data for the percentage of your country's population that have access to reliable internet and bandwidth? Please also indicate the year of publication of this data, and to which year(s) it refers. (ref.: (iii) 18.b)

Year 2023, 91.6 % of population in 2022, https://www.instat.gov.al/media/11157/ict-2022_shqip.pdf

45. 3.3 Are there national research and education networks (NRENs)[i] active in the country? (*ref.: (iii) 18.c*)

[i] A national research and education network (NREN) is a specialised internet service provider dedicated to supporting the needs of the research and education communities within a country.

☒ Yes

☐ No

46. 3.3 cont. **If yes**, please provide more information and links as relevant, and indicate to which open science actors in your country those networks are accessible.

The main NREN in Albania is Albanian Academic Network (AAN). AAN provides a specialized internet infrastructure and services tailored to the needs of the research and education HEI-s across Albania. (<https://www.rash.al/en/> , <https://www.rash.al/en/software/>)

47. 3.4 Are there national or institutional open science infrastructures[i] in your country? (ref.: (iii) 18.d, 18.e, 18.k, 18.l, 18.m)

[i] Some examples of open science infrastructures include major shared scientific equipment or sets of instruments, open computational and data manipulation service infrastructures that enable collaborative and multidisciplinary data analysis, open science platforms and repositories for publications, research data and source codes, archives, open bibliometrics and scientometrics systems for assessing and analysing scientific domains, open laboratories, software forges and virtual research environments, open innovation testbeds, incubators, science museums, science parks and infrastructure for non-digital materials.



Yes



Under development



No

48. 3.4 cont. **If yes or under development**, please indicate which type(s) of infrastructure:



federated information technology infrastructure for open science, including high-performance computing, cloud computing and data storage



community managed infrastructures, protocols and standards, for example those that support bibliodiversity and engagement with society



platforms for exchanges and co-creation of knowledge between scientists and society



community-based monitoring and information systems to complement national, regional and global data and information systems

49. 3.4 cont. **If yes or under development**, for each infrastructure, please provide links as relevant and more information with regard to their compliance with the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science in terms of inclusivity, accessibility, interoperability, community governance, FAIR (Findable, Accessible, Interoperable, and Reusable) and CARE (Collective Benefit, Authority to Control, Responsibility and Ethics) principles. Please indicate if the infrastructure is non-commercial.

The Ministry of Education and Sports, in collaboration with NASRI and National Information Society Agency (NAIS), is working on the development of the ACRIS platform. This platform will serve as a dynamic database that will promote Open Science and will contain all research products in our country. <https://akshi.gov.al/programi-digjital-i-be-se/> The Center for Coordination and Dissemination of Scientific Information (QKPISH) is a unit within the Academy of Sciences of Albania (ASA) that coordinates the online network of common scientific research and information centers in Albania. This is done through the platforms COBISS.AL (the common bibliographic online system and services in Albania) and ECRIS.AL (the information system for research activities in Albania), which aim to digitize, increase, and enrich indexed information, as well as provide access to content related to scientific creativity in Albania and beyond. At the national level, 890 researchers have been registered in the ECRIS.AL system. For more information, you can refer to the following links: • COBISS Albania: <https://al.cobiss.net/sherbimi-cobiss-shqiptar/> • Academy of Sciences of Albania: <https://akad.gov.al/qendra-e-koordinimit-dheperhapies-se-informacionit-shkencor-qkpish/> The digitization of scientific publications of the Academy is carried out through the dCOBISS (Digital Repository COBISS) platform: <https://al.cobiss.net/repositori-digjital/>. This includes monographs and publications from institutes, such as periodicals like: • Studime Historike (2007–2023): <https://plus.cobiss.net/cobiss/al/sq/bib/bash/1537980912> • Studime Filologjike (2009–2024): <https://plus.cobiss.net/cobiss/al/sq/bib/bash/1537995504> • Albanian Studies (2018–2024): <https://plus.cobiss.net/cobiss/al/sq/bib/bash/2048446538> • Studime për Artin (2018–2023): <https://plus.cobiss.net/cobiss/al/sq/bib/bash/2048445002> • Studia Albanica (1995–2023): <https://plus.cobiss.net/cobiss/al/sq/bib/bash/5116170> • Candavia (2004–2024): <https://plus.cobiss.net/cobiss/al/sq/bib/bash/2048446282> • Iliria (2004–2022): <https://drive.google.com/file/d/ImCT8KzwUjx3TbyH9UJsCIDhDpujHSIW/view> • Antropologjia (2003–2022): <https://plus.cobiss.net/cobiss/al/sq/bib/bash/2048418093> • AJNTS (2014–2023): <https://plus.cobiss.net/cobiss/al/sq/bib/bash/335989248> Bibliographic records in the shared COBIB.AL database amount to approximately 158,685. This effort represents a significant step in the digitization and dissemination of scientific knowledge in Albania, contributing to the promotion of open science in the country.

50. 3.5 Does your country host or fund any federated regional or international information technology infrastructure for open science? (ref.: (iii) 18.e, 18.f)

☒ Yes

☐ No

51. 3.5. cont. **If yes**, please provide links as relevant and more information, including the name of the infrastructure, date of establishment, language, target groups and beneficiaries, governance/community agreements, scope (e.g. research areas, elements of open science, stage of research, accessibility to all the relevant users in the region or internationally).

According to the Albanian Academic Network (AAN) The country is involved in the Open Access Research Infrastructure in the Western Balkans Support Programme, which aims to guide the preparation of Open Access policies for selected research infrastructures in the region, including Albania. Additionally, Albania is a member of the National Initiatives for Open Science in Europe (NI4OS-Europe) project. Through this initiative, Albania has established the AI4OS (Albanian Initiative for Open Science) coalition, which focuses on promoting and implementing Open Science policies within higher education institutions and research infrastructures. AI4OS also coordinates activities related to integrating national infrastructures and services into the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC), facilitating academic and research access to EOSC resources. <https://ni4os.eu/15-national-osc-initiatives/albania/>

52. 3.6 Is your country involved in any North-South, North-South-South and South-South collaborations to optimize infrastructure use and joint strategies for shared, multinational, regional and national open science platforms? (ref.: (iii) 18.g)

☒ Yes

☐ No

53. 3.6 cont. **If yes**, please provide links as relevant and more information, including the name of the infrastructure, date of establishment, language, target groups and beneficiaries, governance/community agreements, scope (e.g. research areas, elements of open science, stage of research, accessibility to all the relevant users in the region or internationally).

We actively engage in collaborations to optimize infrastructure use and joint strategies for shared open science platforms. Albania is an associated country in Horizon Europe. This association enables Albanian researchers to collaborate with partners from EU member states and other associated countries, fostering the development of open science platforms and infrastructure. The Albanian Initiative for Open Science (AI4OS) is a national coalition promoting open science policies in higher education institutions and research infrastructures. AI4OS aims to establish a national cloud for open science, integrating Albania into the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC) ecosystem. <https://ni4os.eu/15-national-osc-initiatives/albania/> Open Access Research Infrastructure Support Programme launched by the Regional Cooperation Council (RCC), assists the development of research infrastructures in the Western Balkans, including Albania. It focuses on creating open access policies and training staff to implement open science practices, thereby enhancing regional cooperation. https://www.rcc.int/working_groups/60/open-access-research-infrastructure-in-the-western-balkans-support-programme

Part 4. INVESTING IN HUMAN RESOURCES, TRAINING, EDUCATION, DIGITAL LITERACY

AND CAPACITY BUILDING FOR OPEN SCIENCE

54. 4.1 Has systematic capacity building on open science taken place in higher education and/or research performing institutions in your country? (ref.: (iv) 19.a, 19.c)

☒ Yes

☐ No

55. 4.1 cont. **If yes**, please indicate if those capacity building initiatives are formal or informal and provide more information and links as relevant.

Systematic capacity building on open science is performed in higher education and research-performing institutions. Albanian universities, in collaboration with national and international partners, have organized various workshops and seminars to raise awareness about open science practices. These training sessions focus on topics such as open access to research, open data, open educational resources (OER), and the use of open science tools and platforms. Albania's participation in European programs such as Horizon Europe has also led to the organization of workshops on open science principles, aiming to train researchers on how to properly manage and disseminate data, publications, and other scientific outputs in an open and transparent manner. The Academy of Sciences of Albania through its Center for Coordination and Dissemination of Scientific Information (QKPISH) is also playing a role in capacity building by coordinating national initiatives on open access and encouraging the adoption of open science practices within research-performing institutions. <https://al.cobiss.net/>

56. 4.2 Have capacity building programmes for policy makers on how to integrate core values and principles of open science in STI policies and strategies taken place in your country?

☒ Yes

☐ No

57. 4.2 cont. **If yes**, please provide more information and links as relevant.

Capacity-building programs for policymakers on how to integrate core values and principles of open science into Science, Technology, and Innovation (STI) policies and strategies have been included in New Law on Science and Scientific Research in the Republic of Albania and the National Strategy for Scientific Research, Technology, and Innovation 2023-2030. These documents aim to ensure that open science becomes a key pillar of promoting transparency, inclusivity, and international collaboration. The new Law No. 109/2024 "On Science and Scientific Research in the Republic of Albania" explicitly mandates the integration of open science principles into national policies, emphasizing open access to research outputs, data sharing, and the collaborative development of scientific knowledge. It highlights the importance of training policymakers to understand the practical and strategic implications of open science in decision-making processes. The National Strategy for Scientific research, technology, and innovation 2023-2030 outlines targeted capacity-building efforts.

<https://qbz.gov.al/eli/vendim/2023/09/20/542/96f316d6-b135-42fb-a64a-abbfbfa9484c8>

<https://qbz.gov.al/eli/ligj/2024/10/31/109/1ad3354e-0611-4997-bdcf-3e4526ae2f50>

58. 4.3 Has a framework of open science competencies been incorporated into higher education research skills curricula in your country, or is it foreseen by the end of 2025? (ref.: (iv) 19.b)

☒ Yes

☐ No

59. 4.3 cont. **If yes**, please provide more information and links as relevant.

A comprehensive framework for open science competencies is not yet fully incorporated into higher education and research skills curricula. However, some interventions are done toward integrating open science into the education and research area. In Higher Education Institutions, certain aspects related to open science are presented through various educational and research programs. Some HEI-s include components of open data sharing, open access publishing, and other open science practices in their research methodology courses. Participation in EU research projects and other international collaborations provides a significant opportunity to foster the development of open science competencies in Albania. Institutions participating in these projects are often required to implement open science practices, and this creates an opportunity for training, workshops, and skills development for researchers and students. Additionally, funding opportunities from programs such as Horizon Europe encourage Albanian institutions to align with open science principles, which could lead to further curriculum changes and the integration of open science competencies into the educational framework.

60. 4.4 Are open educational resources[i] as defined in the 2019 Recommendation on Open Educational Resources, used as an instrument for open science capacity building in your country in line with the 2019 Recommendation mentioned above? (ref.: (iv) 19.d)

[i] Open Educational Resources are learning, teaching and research materials in any format and medium that reside in the public domain or are under copyright that have been released under an open license, that permit no-cost access, re-use, re-purpose, adaptation and redistribution by others (2019 Recommendation on Open Educational Resources)

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ Partly
- ☐ No

61. 4.5 Have there been any initiatives in your country to support science communication in line with open science value and principles with a view to the dissemination of scientific knowledge to researchers of different disciplines, decision-makers and the public at large? (ref.: (iv) 19.e)

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No

62. 4.5 cont. If yes, please provide more information and links as relevant.

The Academy of Sciences of Albania (ASA) plays a role in promoting science communication. It publishes a wide range of scientific journals and periodicals in various disciplines. Many of these publications are available through platforms like COBISS.AL, ECRIS.AL, and dCOBISS, which provide open access to scholarly articles and publications, making scientific knowledge accessible to the public and researchers. The Academy has also been involved in the organization of conferences, workshops, and public talks aimed at fostering dialogue between scientists, policymakers, and the general public. These initiatives help translate scientific findings into language that is understandable and relevant for a wider audience. NASRI has been active in organizing events and creating platforms to communicate scientific research and innovations. The agency has supported the publication of research results and scientific reports on their website and in collaboration with other institutions. This ensures that important findings are disseminated across different sectors of society. Through EU-funded programs and international projects, NASRI also contributes to building stronger research communication networks, which help disseminate research results in alignment with open science principles. Some HEI-s and research institutions are also engaged in science communication activities. This is done through producing videos, hosting public lectures, and organizing science fairs that showcase ongoing research to the public. Some HEI-s have been involved in outreach activities to promote scientific literacy and facilitate public engagement with scientific topics. <https://akad.gov.al/botime/> , <https://nasri.gov.al/aktivitete/>

Part 5. FOSTERING A CULTURE OF OPEN SCIENCE AND ALIGNING INCENTIVES FOR OPEN SCIENCE

63. 5.1 Have there been any initiatives at the national or institutional level, e.g. by universities and/or research performing institutions, to review the existing research assessment and evaluation processes in order to align them with open science principles and values or are they foreseen by the end of 2025? (ref.: (v) 20.b, 20c, 20i)

☒ Yes

☐ No

64. 5.1 cont. If yes, please provide more information and links as relevant.

There have been discussions aimed at reviewing and aligning existing research assessment and evaluation processes with the principles and values of open science. The objective is to adapt research evaluation frameworks and policies to reflect the open science values, such as transparency, open data, and public access to scientific knowledge. The National Strategy for Science, Technology, and Innovation 2023-2030 emphasizes the importance of fostering open science practices in research and innovation. The strategy acknowledges the need to review the research assessment processes to ensure that they align with open science principles, including promoting the transparency of research outputs, data, and methodologies. At the institutional level, HEI-s are discussing the inclusion of open science practices as part of their evaluation criteria. While traditional metrics such as journal impact factor, citations, and H-index are still predominant, there is growing acknowledgment of the importance of open data, open access publications, and public engagement in research evaluation. Involvement in EU-funded research programs (e.g., Horizon Europe) and other international collaborations has stimulated discussions on aligning research assessment and evaluation with open science principles. As part of these initiatives, we are likely to align our research assessment and evaluation systems to reflect international standards for open science.

65. 5.2 Have specific clauses that recognize open science practices, including sharing, collaborating and engaging with other researchers and societal actors beyond the scientific community, or dialogue with other knowledge systems, been incorporated in the career evaluation and progression systems or are foreseen by the end of 2025? (ref.: (v) 20.a, 20.c, 20.d)

☒ Yes

☐ No

66. 5.2 cont. If yes, please provide details and links as relevant.

The integration of open science practice, such as sharing, collaborating, and engaging with societal actors beyond the scientific community into career evaluation and progression systems is progressing. Institutions and HEI-s have begun to emphasize the importance of open science practices in the context of research and academic output. At present, career evaluations within research performing institutions primarily focus on traditional academic indicators such as published papers, citations, and funding acquisition. There is minimal formal recognition of open science practices such as data sharing, collaborative research, or public engagement with non-scientific actors. The National Strategy for Science, Technology, and Innovation (2023-2030) and The Law No. 109/2024 "On science and scientific research in Republic of Albania", lay the groundwork for introducing these changes.

67. 5.3 Have there been any initiatives in your country to recognize and reward open science practices or are they foreseen by the end of 2025? (ref.: (v) 20.a, 20.b, 20.c, 20.e, 20.f, 20.g, 20h)

☒ Yes

☐ No

68. 5.3 cont. **If yes**, for each initiative, please provide more information, including on the stakeholders[i] that are involved or lead the initiative, and links as relevant.

[i] For example, research funders, universities, research institutions, learned societies, scientific publishers and journal editorial boards.

There have been efforts to recognize and reward open science practices, and there are plans to further develop such initiatives by the end of 2025. With the entry into force of the new Law No. 109/2024 "On Science and Scientific Research in the Republic of Albania" by-laws will be developed/issued to provide a clear framework for the implementation of open science principles. Specifically, a Council of Ministers' Decision will be issued that will outline the standards and criteria essential for implementing open science. This decision will not only cover the technical and ethical aspects of open access, open data, but will also introduce initiatives aimed at recognizing and rewarding the application of open science practices. However, there are institutions/HEI-s considering open science practices in their evaluation criteria for research output. This includes measuring not only the number of publications but also the openness of research, such as: Open-access publications in high-impact journals, Data sharing and the availability of research datasets in public repositories. These practices are also linked to career advancement and awards in academia. The Academy of Sciences has developed a tradition and ongoing practice for evaluating the scientific work and activities of various groups or individuals. In this regard, continuous initiatives have been undertaken to organize the awarding of various evaluative prizes in different fields of science, based on publicly announced criteria and an impartial evaluation system, focusing on merit and the impact of scientific work. These include the "Aleksa Buda" Prize, the "Pilika" Scientific Prize, the "Eqrem Cabej" Prize, the "Petrir Radovicka" Prize, among others.

69. 5.4 Have there been any unintended negative consequences[i] of open science practices reported in your country? (ref.: (v) 20)

[i] For example, predatory behaviours, data migration, exploitation and privatization of research data, increased costs for scientists and high article processing charges associated with certain business models in scientific publishing that may be causes of inequality for the scientific communities around the world and, in some cases, the loss of intellectual property and knowledge.

☐ Yes

☒ No

Part 6. PROMOTING INNOVATIVE APPROACHES FOR OPEN SCIENCE AT DIFFERENT STAGES

OF THE SCIENTIFIC PROCESS

70. 6.1 Have there been any initiatives at the national or institutional level that promote innovative, participatory methodological or procedural changes at different stages of the research cycle to increase the openness of the entire scientific process? (ref.: (vi) 21)

☐ YES, at the national level

☐ YES, at the institutional level

☒ YES, at both the national and institutional levels

☐ No

71. 6.1 cont. **If yes**, please indicate which of the recommended actions they address:

- ☐ promotion of pre-prints
- ☒ exploration of open peer-review practices
- ☐ valuing and sharing of negative scientific results and associated data
- ☒ participatory methods that value inputs from societal actors, e.g. citizen science, crowdsourcing scientific projects
- ☒ development of participatory strategies for identifying the needs of marginalized communities and highlighting socially relevant issues to be incorporated into research agendas
- ☒ promoting open innovation practices
- ☐ Other

72. 6.1. cont. **If yes**, please provide more information and links as relevant

As part of the Academy of Sciences of Albania (ASA), the Center for Coordination and Dissemination of Scientific Information (QKPISH) has developed COBISS.AL, an online shared bibliographic system, and ECRIS.AL, an information system that tracks research activities in Albania. These platforms support openness in the research cycle by providing public access to bibliographic records and detailed data about the research landscape in the country. A digital extension of COBISS dCOBISS (Digital Repository) is aimed at the digital preservation and dissemination of scientific publications, making research more accessible to the public and the academic community. By increasing access to research outputs, this initiative supports the transparency and participatory nature of the research cycle. HEI-s, the Academy of Sciences, and research centers, are exploring the use of open science platforms that facilitate collaborative research and data sharing across institutions, both within Albania and internationally. These platforms encourage a participatory research cycle, where researchers can share their work, receive feedback, and engage with the public. <https://al.cobiss.net/repositori-digjital/> , <https://www.cobiss.net/al/> <https://cit.edu.al/save-the-date-seminar-on-friday-7th-of-may-2021-at-1400/> , <https://www.unyt.edu.al/article/kick-off-meeting-for-the-giteka-project> , <https://www.unyt.edu.al/article/highlights-from-the-web-nimbus-kick-off-event> , <https://www.facebook.com/unyt.edu.al/posts/-on-february-3-4-2025-the-university-of-new-york-tirana-is-proudly-hosting-the-k/1022358543260302/> , <https://cit.edu.al/supporting-quality-research-in-albania-2016-2018/> , <https://cit.edu.al/how-to-handle-scientific-research-open-lecture/> , <https://cit.edu.al/the-future-2030-conference/> , <https://cit.edu.al/intellectual-property-and-its-importance-in-promoting-innovation-among-students-informative-session/>

Part 7. PROMOTING INTERNATIONAL AND MULTI-STAKEHOLDER COOPERATION IN THE CONTEXT

OF OPEN SCIENCE AND WITH VIEW TO REDUCING DIGITAL, TECHNOLOGICAL AND KNOWLEDGE GAPS

73. 7.1 How is your country promoting and facilitating international scientific collaborations on open science as outlined in the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science? (ref.: (vii) 22.a)

The MoES plays a key role in improving international collaboration in open science. According to the Strategy of Science, Technology, and Innovation 2023-2030, the Ministry is fostering international cooperation by promoting open science practices in policy development, and cross-border research projects. The MoES also supports international research networks, facilitating participation in European Union research programs (e.g., Horizon Europe), which emphasize open science principles. NASRI facilitates Albania's participation in international collaborations by supporting open science frameworks and aligning national research with EU-level initiatives. Through these collaborations, NASRI aims to contribute to the creation of open science infrastructures, and to facilitate researchers' participation in international research networks, allowing the exchange of scientific knowledge with global stakeholders. The Academy of Sciences through participation in international scientific organizations, conferences, and collaborations is promoting the exchange of open scientific knowledge and best practices on open science, while also emphasizing the importance of open dialogue with stakeholders across different sectors. The Durrës Technology Park and other innovation hubs in Albania encourage international partnerships for open innovation and research collaboration. These hubs are designed to foster cross-border collaborative innovation, supporting open science initiatives in ICT, health, and environmental research, among other fields. The parks and hubs provide infrastructure for the sharing of research data and open innovation, facilitating joint projects and the free flow of information between international stakeholders. According to Academy of Science, evidence of this commitment can be seen through successful engagements in applying the principles of Open Science with international and multi-party cooperation, as highlighted below:

- 1. International Conference in the Field of Nanotechnology:
 - 21st Edition of the International Conference on Trends in Nanotechnology (TNT2021), held from October 4–8, 2021. More information can be found at TNT2021 Program.
 - 22nd Edition of the International Conference on Trends in Nanotechnology (TNT2022), held from October 3–7, 2022. More details are available at TNT2022 About.
 - nanoBalkan 2023, held from October 16–20, 2023. For more information, visit nanoBalkan 2023.
 - nanoBalkan 2024, scheduled for October 28–November 1, 2024. Details are available at nanoBalkan 2024.

These events demonstrate the commitment to fostering international partnerships and promoting Open Science principles, particularly in the rapidly advancing field of nanotechnology. https://investment.com.al/wp-content/uploads/2024/10/Durana-Tech-Park_Draft-Development-Plan_EN.pdf , https://ambasadat.gov.al/serbia/wp-content/uploads/sites/32/2024/11/Durana-Tech-Park_Development-Plan_PPT_EN.pdf

74. 7.2 Does your country have a strategy or a plan for stimulating cross-border multi-stakeholder collaboration on open science, including with regards to exchange of best practices, capacity building and metrics for open science? (ref.: (vii) 22.b, 22.e, 22.f)

☒ Yes

☐ No

75. 7.2 cont. **If yes**, please provide links as relevant and more information.

Working towards EU integration process, we are aligning our policies with EU standards. This includes participation in EU-funded programs such as Horizon Europe, where the region is actively involved in cross-border collaborations in research and innovation. Horizon Europe not only promotes open access to research outputs but also supports collaborative projects among member and associated countries, fostering multi-stakeholder collaboration. Regional Cooperation Council (RCC), where Albania is part of it, also promotes collaborative research in the region. This network includes multiple stakeholders, including universities, research centers, industry representatives from the Western Balkans, facilitating the exchange of joint research efforts, and capacity building activities focused on open science. Another example of collaboration is NanoAlb Center, part of the Academy of Sciences of Albania. This center is based on the cooperation of research groups from the Balkans (Albania, Kosovo, North Macedonia, Serbia) and beyond (Spain, Greece, Israel, Italy), working together on scientific research, exchanging best practices, and supporting capacity-building initiatives. The NanoAlb Ignite project aims to promote collaborations between research groups from the NanoAlb community and with other national and international institutions. The goal is to facilitate knowledge exchange among scientists working in various fields and to explore new collaboration opportunities in the areas of nanoscience, nanotechnology, and significant applications in healthcare, material science, the environment, food security, construction, and agricultural applications.

https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/common/guidance/list-3rd-country-participation_horizon-euratom_en.pdf , <https://www.unsdsn.org/our-networks/western-balkans/>

76. 7.3 Is your country involved in any discussion on the establishment of regional and international funding mechanisms for open science? (ref.: (vii) 22.c)

☒ Yes

☐ No

77. 7.3 cont. **If yes**, please provide links as relevant and more information.

Albania is part of Horizon Europe, the EU's primary funding program for research and innovation, which promotes open science across Europe. Through its participation in this program, Albania contributes to and benefits from the ongoing discussions on funding mechanisms that encourage open access publishing, data sharing, collaborative research, and other open science principles. Albania is member of the Western Balkans region, where there are ongoing efforts to establish regional funding mechanisms for open science. Albania has been involved in discussions aimed at increasing regional collaboration in science and technology, ensuring that funding mechanisms for open science are accessible to researchers and institutions in the region. These discussions also include the co-funding of collaborative projects and the establishment of open science funding mechanisms that encourage cross-border cooperation. https://ec.europa.eu/info/funding-tenders/opportunities/docs/2021-2027/common/guidance/list-3rd-country-participation_horizon-euratom_en.pdf

Part 8. GENERAL CONSIDERATIONS

78. 8.1 Are there any specific external causes that may impede the implementation of the 2021 UNESCO Recommendation on Open Science in your country?

☐ Yes

☒ No

79. ANY OTHER COMMENTS: If you wish, you may enter any additional comments or information here. You may also contact openscience@unesco.org

N/A